

Technical Specification Dossier: The Human Biocomputational Architecture — The Ultimate Edge-Computing Biomechatronic System

Marie-Soleil Seshat Landry / Landry Industries

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Abstract

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This dossier provides a systems-level technical specification of the human central nervous system framed as a decentralized, self-healing, self-replicating biocomputational platform. It integrates multimodal sensory telemetry, massively parallel asynchronous processing, content-addressable memory, and continuous structural plasticity within a continuous thermal envelope of approximately 20 W. The architecture is positioned as the reference benchmark for energy-efficient intelligence against which silicon and neuromorphic systems must be measured.

AI Disclosure: Generated via deterministic multi-tier verification protocols under Landry Truthfinding standards. Verified against established neuroscience, sensory physiology, and biophysical data (Herculano-Houzel, Kandel et al., Attwell & Laughlin lineage, and contemporary metabolic studies).

1 Observation and Core Premise

Traditional silicon engineering attempts to reverse-engineer intelligence through brute-force parallelism, high-precision digital logic, and massive power draws. These approaches continuously lag the baseline capabilities of biological organisms in energy efficiency, robustness to noise, continuous online learning, and seamless multimodal integration.

The human central nervous system represents the pinnacle of decentralized edge computing: a self-maintaining, self-repairing biocomputational system that fuses dual-channel optical telemetry, high-fidelity binaural acoustic arrays, full-body proprioceptive and interoceptive networks, chemical sensing, vestibular stabilization, and autonomous multi-timescale reasoning into a compact, mobile package operating on roughly 20 W — less power than a typical household light bulb, while accounting for approximately 20% of whole-body resting metabolic expenditure despite comprising only ~2% of body mass.

2 System Architecture and Hardware Specifications

The human biocomputer functions as a tightly integrated biomechatronic unit. Peripheral sensors stream continuous data into an ultra-dense, sparsely activated neural fabric that performs massively

parallel, asynchronous, event-driven computation via electrochemical signaling rather than rigid synchronous binary logic.

2.1 Optical Sensor Array (Dual Cameras)

Stereoscopic, high-dynamic-range optical capture via dual ocular nodes (retinae). Key performance characteristics include:

- Active autofocus and continuous accommodation via crystalline lens and ciliary muscle.
- Real-time iris aperture control (pupillary light reflex) providing rapid gain control across several orders of magnitude of illuminance.
- Variable temporal resolution: capable of supporting high-speed motion tracking during saccades and microsaccades; perceptual temporal resolution for simple features can reach the order of 8–30 ms depending on feature type.
- Color discrimination spanning millions of distinct hues under photopic conditions (commonly cited range 1–10 million discriminable colors), mediated by three cone classes (L, M, S) plus rod contribution under mesopic/scotopic conditions.
- Foveal spatial resolution approaching or exceeding 60–94 pixels per degree under optimal conditions for achromatic detail.

2.2 Acoustic Array (Dual Microphones)

Binaural spatial audio processing units with:

- Frequency detection range approximately 20 Hz to 20 kHz in young, healthy listeners (functional limits nearer 16 Hz–18 kHz under typical conditions).
- Sub-millisecond interaural time difference (ITD) resolution; best just-noticeable differences approach 10 μ s near 700 Hz, enabling precise azimuthal localization.
- Interaural level difference (ILD) and spectral-shape cues for elevation and front/back disambiguation.
- Sophisticated adaptive noise cancellation and stream segregation performed centrally.

2.3 Integrated Multimodal Sensor Suite

- **Somatosensory / Haptic network:** Dense arrays of mechanoreceptors (Meissner, Merkel, Ruffini, Pacinian), nociceptors, and thermoreceptors distributed across the integumentary system and deeper tissues. Provide high-bandwidth pressure, vibration, stretch, temperature, and tissue-damage signals.
- **Proprioceptive network:** Muscle spindles, Golgi tendon organs, and joint receptors enabling continuous body-state estimation and closed-loop motor control.
- **Vestibular system:** Semi-circular canals and otolith organs delivering high-bandwidth angular and linear acceleration data for balance, gaze stabilization (VOR), and spatial orientation.
- **Chemical sensors:** Olfactory epithelium and gustatory receptors providing molecular identification and valence signaling.
- **Interoceptive channels:** Visceral afferents monitoring internal physiological state (cardiac, respiratory, metabolic, immune).

2.4 Central Processing Unit (Neural Core)

- Approximately 8.6×10^{10} (86 billion) neurons (Herculano-Houzel isotropic fractionator estimates).

- Roughly 1×10^{14} – 1.5×10^{14} (100–150 trillion) dynamic chemical synapses, plus gap-junction electrical synapses in specialized circuits.
- Massively parallel, asynchronous, event-driven execution with sparse activation; most neurons fire at low average rates.
- Estimated computational throughput on the order of 10^{15} – 10^{16} synaptic operations per second under realistic activity regimes, achieved at ~ 20 W.

2.5 Power and Thermal Profile

Continuous whole-brain power consumption of approximately 17 – 20 W under typical awake conditions, derived primarily from glucose oxidation. This yields an energy efficiency orders of magnitude superior to contemporary digital supercomputers performing comparable pattern-recognition or sensory-integration workloads. Cortical gray matter accounts for the majority of the signaling-related budget; synaptic transmission is the dominant energy consumer.

3 Memory, Data Storage, and Processing Capacity

Biological memory is content-addressable, distributed, and reconstructive rather than addressable by discrete locations.

- **Working Memory (Executive Buffer):** Limited-capacity, attention-dependent workspace classically modeled as 4 ± 1 to 7 ± 2 concurrent chunks, heavily dependent on prefrontal–parietal networks and continuous rehearsal or attentional refreshing. Supports real-time tactical reasoning and constraint satisfaction.
- **Long-Term Storage:** Distributed, overlapping engrams across neocortical, hippocampal, and subcortical circuits. Capacity estimates based on synaptic information content range from tens of terabytes to several petabytes; a frequently cited figure derived from refined synaptic weight precision is approximately 2.5 PB. Storage is lifelong for many episodic, semantic, and procedural traces, subject to reconsolidation and interference.
- **Reasoning and Inference Engine:** Continuous predictive processing, Bayesian-like inference, counterfactual simulation, analogical mapping, and heuristic search. Operates under radical uncertainty with graceful degradation rather than brittle failure.

4 Advanced Functional Subroutines

Beyond feed-forward sensory processing, the architecture implements specialized and general-purpose cognitive pipelines:

- **Natural Language Processing:** Left-hemisphere-dominant perisylvian networks (including classical Broca and Wernicke territories and their white-matter connections) supporting real-time comprehension, production, syntactic structure building, semantic composition, pragmatic inference, and prosodic modulation.
- **Intuitive Synthesis / “Vibe” Processing:** Rapid, largely non-verbal pattern completion and affective valuation that compresses high-dimensional, partially observed inputs into actionable gist representations and aesthetic or social judgments.
- **Generative Creativity:** Combinatorial recombination of existing knowledge structures guided by predictive error minimization, emotional valence, and cross-domain analogy, producing novel outputs that are constrained by physical and social reality models.

- **Continuous Structural Plasticity:** Experience-dependent synaptic strengthening/weakening (LTP/LTD), synaptic scaling, dendritic spine dynamics, and, to a limited adult extent, neurogenesis. Enables lifelong online learning without catastrophic forgetting under ecological conditions.

5 Performance Envelope and Comparative Benchmarks

Metric	Approximate Value
Neurons	86×10^9
Synapses	$\sim 10^{14}$
Power	~ 20 W
Energy efficiency	Extremely high vs. digital FLOPS/W
Working memory span	4–7 chunks
Long-term capacity estimates	tens of TB to ~ 2.5 PB
Best ITD sensitivity	$\sim 10 \mu\text{s}$
Color discriminability	10^6 – 10^7 hues

The architecture exhibits graceful degradation under partial damage, continuous self-repair (within limits), and autonomous goal-directed behavior across multiple timescales — capabilities that remain frontier challenges for engineered systems.

6 Conclusions and Capability Assessment

The human brain constitutes the reference edge-computing biocomputational engine. Its ability to fuse high-bandwidth multimodal sensory streams, perform real-time probabilistic and heuristic reasoning, maintain a coherent world model, and physically rewire its own substrate in response to experience sets the performance and efficiency baseline against which artificial intelligence, neuromorphic hardware, and advanced robotics must be evaluated.

Any serious effort toward artificial general intelligence or tightly coupled human–machine systems must treat this biological architecture not as a curiosity but as the primary existence proof and engineering target. Understanding its constraints (metabolic cost of signaling, limited working memory, susceptibility to certain classes of illusion and bias, finite lifespan of components) is equally essential for realistic capability and vulnerability analysis.

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